

# C2-09 Senior / BI Interview Companion

Evidence-led defense - open after CAP11 first attempt

## CORE STORY

Situation -> Task -> Action -> Evidence/Result -> Learning. Every strong answer names the decision/problem you owned, what you actually did, how you validated it and one limitation/failure/production reflection.

## TRUTH BOUNDARY

For Meridian or other synthetic/course work say 'in my capstone/project'. For production extensions say 'I would design/use...'. Do not turn a project into employer achievement or years of experience.

## PRACTICE LOOP

Answer once without notes in 60-90 seconds. Shorten while retaining decision/action/validation/limitation. Then answer one changed follow-up. Point to an exact evidence ID/artifact.

# Interview defense - SQL / grain

Evidence -> validation -> limitation -> changed follow-up

## STRONG ANSWER FRAME

Explain output grain, join/cardinality, one window/CTE choice, validation and a failure/fix. Likely follow-ups: How did you know it was correct? Why not another join? What changes at scale?

## RED FLAGS

Tool names with no business/model explanation; memorized formula; no objective validation; hidden failure; claim exceeds saved evidence; production-scale statement presented as something already operated.

## YOUR PRACTICE

Write a 6-line version, name the exact evidence ID/artifact and create one interviewer follow-up that changes a condition. Answer the changed follow-up without reopening notes.

# Interview defense - Model / DAX

Evidence -> validation -> limitation -> changed follow-up

## STRONG ANSWER FRAME

Explain fact/dimension/date roles, relationship/filter direction, one measure in business language, context test and performance/ambiguity trade-off.

## RED FLAGS

Tool names with no business/model explanation; memorized formula; no objective validation; hidden failure; claim exceeds saved evidence; production-scale statement presented as something already operated.

## YOUR PRACTICE

Write a 6-line version, name the exact evidence ID/artifact and create one interviewer follow-up that changes a condition. Answer the changed follow-up without reopening notes.

# Interview defense - Automation

Evidence -> validation -> limitation -> changed follow-up

## STRONG ANSWER FRAME

State input/output contract, reusable steps/functions, validation-before-publish, logging/manifest, one failure and safe rerun.

## RED FLAGS

Tool names with no business/model explanation; memorized formula; no objective validation; hidden failure; claim exceeds saved evidence; production-scale statement presented as something already operated.

## YOUR PRACTICE

Write a 6-line version, name the exact evidence ID/artifact and create one interviewer follow-up that changes a condition. Answer the changed follow-up without reopening notes.

# Interview defense - Data quality

Evidence -> validation -> limitation -> changed follow-up

## STRONG ANSWER FRAME

Name freshness/completeness/uniqueness/validity/FK/reconciliation issue; expected/observed; severity; owner; recovery and post-repair proof.

## RED FLAGS

Tool names with no business/model explanation; memorized formula; no objective validation; hidden failure; claim exceeds saved evidence; production-scale statement presented as something already operated.

## YOUR PRACTICE

Write a 6-line version, name the exact evidence ID/artifact and create one interviewer follow-up that changes a condition. Answer the changed follow-up without reopening notes.

# Interview defense - Stakeholder conflict

Evidence -> validation -> limitation -> changed follow-up

## STRONG ANSWER FRAME

State decision, competing definitions/owners, business impact, authority for final contract and unresolved differences.

## RED FLAGS

Tool names with no business/model explanation; memorized formula; no objective validation; hidden failure; claim exceeds saved evidence; production-scale statement presented as something already operated.

## YOUR PRACTICE

Write a 6-line version, name the exact evidence ID/artifact and create one interviewer follow-up that changes a condition. Answer the changed follow-up without reopening notes.

# Interview defense - Executive communication

Evidence -> validation -> limitation -> changed follow-up

## STRONG ANSWER FRAME

60 seconds: headline -> 1-3 numbers -> implication -> action/owner -> material limitation -> next checkpoint.

## RED FLAGS

Tool names with no business/model explanation; memorized formula; no objective validation; hidden failure; claim exceeds saved evidence; production-scale statement presented as something already operated.

## YOUR PRACTICE

Write a 6-line version, name the exact evidence ID/artifact and create one interviewer follow-up that changes a condition. Answer the changed follow-up without reopening notes.

# Interview defense - Capstone defense

Evidence -> validation -> limitation -> changed follow-up

## STRONG ANSWER FRAME

Separate what you actually built from what you would productionize. Name scale/security/monitoring/orchestration changes only when justified.

## RED FLAGS

Tool names with no business/model explanation; memorized formula; no objective validation; hidden failure; claim exceeds saved evidence; production-scale statement presented as something already operated.

## YOUR PRACTICE

Write a 6-line version, name the exact evidence ID/artifact and create one interviewer follow-up that changes a condition. Answer the changed follow-up without reopening notes.

# Interview defense - Cross-functional handoff

Evidence -> validation -> limitation -> changed follow-up

## STRONG ANSWER FRAME

Engineering: source/grain/schema/freshness/quality/security/acceptance. Finance: governed definition/reconciliation. Product/Operations: decision/workflow constraints.

## RED FLAGS

Tool names with no business/model explanation; memorized formula; no objective validation; hidden failure; claim exceeds saved evidence; production-scale statement presented as something already operated.

## YOUR PRACTICE

Write a 6-line version, name the exact evidence ID/artifact and create one interviewer follow-up that changes a condition. Answer the changed follow-up without reopening notes.

# Interview defense - Failure / learning

Evidence -> validation -> limitation -> changed follow-up

## STRONG ANSWER FRAME

Use a real course/project failure: what failed, how detected, what you changed, how revalidated, what prevention would exist in production.

## RED FLAGS

Tool names with no business/model explanation; memorized formula; no objective validation; hidden failure; claim exceeds saved evidence; production-scale statement presented as something already operated.

## YOUR PRACTICE

Write a 6-line version, name the exact evidence ID/artifact and create one interviewer follow-up that changes a condition. Answer the changed follow-up without reopening notes.

# Interview defense - Truth / salary / title

Evidence -> validation -> limitation -> changed follow-up

## STRONG ANSWER FRAME

Say 'in my project' for synthetic evidence and 'I would' for production extensions. Never invent revenue impact, users, years, salary uplift or employer scope.

## RED FLAGS

Tool names with no business/model explanation; memorized formula; no objective validation; hidden failure; claim exceeds saved evidence; production-scale statement presented as something already operated.

## YOUR PRACTICE

Write a 6-line version, name the exact evidence ID/artifact and create one interviewer follow-up that changes a condition. Answer the changed follow-up without reopening notes.